

Foreign Gifts Analysis

Executive Summary

After investigating the foreign gift dataset, the institutions receiving the greatest monetary amount of gifts, and the institutions receiving the greatest quantity of gifts, do not include UVA. When specifically analyzing Virginia schools in both of these categories, UVA also falls behind its peers. In order to make UVA's donations more competitive, I would recommend UVA to enter the most generous networks and foundations, highlight its research endeavors, and focus on increasing the types of gifts that have more monetary value.

Analysis

The most important variables during the analysis of this dataset were the Institution's Name, the Foreign Gift Amount, the Gift Type, the Country of Gifter, and the Gifter Name. There were three types of gifts: monetary, contracts, and real estate, with monetary and contract gifts being the most common.

Overall, the countries that donate the greatest amount of money are Qatar, England, China, Saudi Arabia, and Bermuda. The institutions receiving the greatest flow of money are countries such as Cornell University, Carnegie Mellon University, Georgetown University, and Virginia Commonwealth University. The average amount of gifts received by each university is \$52,202,878.97, and the median gift amount received is \$6,486,791.50.

When specifically looking at UVA's donations, the average gift amount received is \$1,479,282.5, and the median is \$900,000. Compared to the average and median values for the entire dataset, UVA's values are much lower. Compared to other Virginia institutions, which are the College of William & Mary, George Mason University, Virginia Commonwealth University, and Virginia Polytechnic Institute & State University, UVA consistently falls behind VCU and GMU in total gift amount, average gift amount, and median gift amount.

Total Foreign Gift Amount		Average Foreign Gift Amount		Median Foreign Gift Amount	
VCU	\$89,163,583	GMU	\$1,721,990	GMU	\$507,054
GMU	\$65,435,604	VCU	\$775,336	VT	\$350,000
UVA	\$22,189,238	VT	\$491,336	UVA	\$80,535
VT	\$11,792,062	UVA	\$226,421	W&M	\$51,600
W&M	\$3,384,498	W&M	\$199,088	VCU	\$33,750

Based on the median gift amount, UVA has a drastically lower amount compared to GMU; however, it is higher than VCU, implying that VCU has had very large donations skewing its gift amount. VCU is one of the top institutions for money flow with its donations being from Qatar. Qatar's foundations who donate the most are the Qatar Foundation, Qatar National Research, and Qatar for Education. On the other hand UVA's top donors are the following countries: England, Israel, Bangladesh, Sweden, and Finland, and the top donating foundations are AstraZeneca, Intrnl Centre Diarrheal Disease, and Haydom Lutheran Hospital.

Strategy

Compared to other Virginia Institutions, UVA is not as competitive as the institution could be. Currently, UVA falls behind its peers in gift amount. One change UVA could make to increase money is to focus more on contract gift types over monetary gift types. UVA is the only Virginia school to have recorded both gift types, while the other Institutions appear to focus more on contracts. With contracts, it might be more likely for the amount to be larger than if it was a monetary gift. Another potential source of money for UVA could be expanding its national network. UVA's top donors excluding England, are Israel, Bangladesh, Sweden, and Finland. These countries are not in the top twenty countries donating to institutions by cash flow. UVA should strive to connect with the most charitable countries who are already donating to similar institutions to increase the amount of gifts they receive. For example, Qatar not only donates to VCU, another Virginia school, but its donating foundations are centered around research and education. If UVA highlighted their research to these foundations, showing that their values align with these foundations, they could potentially increase their donated amounts. Lastly, because England is already a large donor, UVA could strengthen their relationship to increase their donations.

Summary

Despite being a large and reputable school, UVA's received gifts from donors are not as competitive as they could be. A few ways to increase the monetary flow from countries to UVA could be expanding its network to countries like Qatar and Bermuda, primarily focusing on contracts over monetary gifts, highlighting different aspects of the institution to align values, and strengthening already existing connections.